

The Seed



The Temple of Mercury on one leaf

Everything needed to begin, and enough of the Temple to know what you are beginning. Copy it. Change it. Give it away. Keep the spine, and it is this Temple.

IS THIS FOR YOU?

—◆—
What the Temple of Mercury offers

This is a journaling practice with a god in it.

DO YOU WANT MORE?

More done, more made, more luck, more life? More ideas than finished projects, more talent than follow-through? Read on.

WHAT IT IS

It is deceptively simple. Write semi-regularly, and every time you do, reread earlier entries and answer them. Your notebook becomes a running conversation with your past self instead of a pile of pages you never open again.

Research on expressive and reflective writing has linked habits like this to lower stress, clearer thinking, and better problem-solving. Ten honest minutes you will repeat beat an hour you will dread.

One rule makes it work: do not lie to the Book. A lie in your dialogue with yourself deceives only your future self, and that is all it does.

WHAT THIS OFFERS

THE POINT. To help you become someone whose word is good and whose life moves in the direction you choose, and to enjoy the crossing.

WHAT YOU GET. A practice: an honest place to think, and a loop that turns intention into deed. A record: a conversation with yourself that compounds. A vessel: structure for a quick, scattered mind. A home for it: a god, a company, a calendar, and a Temple, so it is worth returning to. And, if you want it, the magick: attention turned toward opportunity, a word the Temple carries, and a way to put your whole weight behind a choice.

WHAT IT DOES NOT PROMISE. Rescue, guaranteed results, anything after death, or a world that bends without action.

THE EVIDENCE. The practice is built from techniques with good research behind them for helping people follow through on goals they choose. Whether it changes the course of your life is what your own Tally will tell you. The research is gathered in *Why It Works* (XXXIII).

BEYOND THE PRACTICE

The practice is the door. The Temple of Mercury is what lies beyond it: luck, knowledge, abundance, and success, reached through your own faculties.

The Temple feeds your writing with answers and flashes of insight. Its practices draw on the god of the crossing to show you how you actually solve problems, answer impossible questions, make new things real, and get paid. You come to it as a co-conspirator, and the gods are willing to help. When you truly want something and walk toward it, the world conspires with you. Conspire is the Temple's word: to breathe together. It does not act for you; it breathes with the one who is already moving.

This is the old work of turning lead into gold, in both senses: knowing yourself, as the alchemists meant it, and trading goods, services, and ideas for money.

WHAT MAGICK DOES, AND DOES NOT DO

Magick nudges the odds. It helps you find favor and opportunity, brings people into your life who can help you, and walks you forward through what seemed impossible. You still have to take physical action toward what you want. That never goes away, and anything promising to take it away is lying.

WHERE THE MAGICK STARTS

It starts smaller than you think: with a promise to yourself, kept. Write down one thing you will do, and do it. Then another. Every promise kept makes your word a little heavier, and a heavy word is what makes a declaration work.

That is the shape of the whole thing. Weigh your words before you write or speak them. Treat what you write and say as binding unless you say otherwise. Keep what you bind. Integrity is not the price of the magick; it is

the magick, and the world begins to take you at your word.

A SYSTEM OF BELIEF

The Temple provides a system of belief, and belief is used here as a tool. Mercury does not moralize; he is the god of merchants and thieves alike. You are free to choose, and not free from the consequences. The Compass is always an option and never an obligation. As above, so below: you reap what you sow.

You do not have to believe any of it to begin. Try the writing and watch your life. The magick will be here when you want it.

WHAT STOPS PEOPLE

"I'VE TRIED JOURNALING AND QUIT." Most journals die because no one rereads them. This one lives because you answer it.

"I DON'T KNOW WHAT TO WRITE." Finish three sentences: What's on my mind right now is... What I keep avoiding is... What I actually want is... They never run out.

"SOMEONE MIGHT READ IT." Keep it with you, or write in your own shorthand. The Book is private.

"I'M NOT RELIGIOUS." You don't have to be. The practice works on its own.

"I DON'T HAVE TIME." Three lines is a session.

WHAT WE WANT

A world full of people fulfilling their Personal Legend. This simple, semi-regular practice can start anyone who keeps it down the road toward the life they have always wanted to live. We help because we like to see people make it further. If the Temple works for you, pass the luck on.

ARE YOU A MERCURIAN?

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The signs of those the Temple calls

THE MERCURIAN

Mercury is the god of the quick: of merchants and messengers, deals and roads, luck, speech, and thieves. A Mercurian is a person who runs on his current. Mercurians are not made by joining. They recognize themselves.

THE SIGNS

YOU THINK IN WORDS. Writing or speaking is how you find out what you think.

YOU TRANSLATE. You carry meaning between worlds, and people bring you things to explain.

YOU ARE CURIOUS PAST USEFULNESS. You gather systems, symbols, and connections for the joy of seeing how they fit, and keep many works alive at once.

YOU ARE QUICK. You learn fast, improvise well, and can walk a road without knowing where it ends.

YOU STAND IN DOORWAYS. People find you when they are crossing: the teacher, the guide, the one called in the night.

YOU PLAY. Riddles, wordplay, clever solutions, and the angle no one else saw.

YOU CONNECT. You are happiest when something is moving between people: ideas, introductions, trade, stories.

YOU HOLD TWO AT ONCE. You argue fruitfully with yourself, and sometimes sense a twin walking beside you.

THE LEAK

The Mercurian's problem is rarely talent. It is leakage: scattered attention, unfinished work, a mind that circles without landing, clever words used to dodge what you actually feel. It is the same quicksilver that makes you quick,

spilling out of anything that cannot hold it. Quicksilver takes the shape of its vessel. Give it one, and it goes where you point it.

WHAT THE PRACTICE GIVES

FOLLOW-THROUGH. Every session ends with one thing to carry into the world, and the next one asks whether you did.

CLARITY. Rereading your own pages shows you what you keep circling, what you keep dodging, and what actually works.

A RECORD THAT COMPOUNDS. Every honest page adds to a conversation with who you were and who you are becoming.

LUCK IN MOTION. The Greeks called a lucky find a hermaion, a gift of Hermes. It comes to the one who is moving.

COMPANY. A god of the quick at your shoulder, and a lineage of tricksters, scribes, and messengers behind you.

THE INVITATION

You will be surprised by what you uncover, and you will uncover it at your own pace. You never have to write about anything you are not ready to. You can stop anytime. You owe nothing, and your Books are yours.

Try it three times this week. Before you turn the page, decide when and where: after what, and at which table? Write the three days on the first page of a notebook, and keep them. That is your first promise, and your first working.

THE TEMPLE OF MERCURY



The Seed: the whole Temple in brief, for whoever finds it

THE SPINE

Mercury is the Hinge. The Heart is the center. Honesty is the offering. Keep these three, and change everything else.

MERCURY, THE HOST AND MEDIUM. God of thresholds, words, trade, and the road. Everything in the Temple passes through him. You work with him, not for him.

THE HEART. The Quintessence: five names from the Enochian Tablet of Union, AONT at the still point, with EHNB, XCAI, RMTO, and PAAM around it. It has no face, and it answers in flashes.

HONESTY, THE OFFERING. Not as a virtue: as engineering. A Book you lie to gives you bad data. Honesty is not the same as disclosure: tell the Book everything, and the world only what it is ready to receive.

THE DOOR

Every session opens and closes. Change the words until they sound like you and you mean them.

Opening:

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices, co-conspirators in the Work:

I bring you my whole self: my Voice, and my Joy, Will, and Intent.

Deed into word. By my Birthright, the Door is open.

Closing:

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices:

I leave here my gratitude and my joy, and take my Will and Intent into the world.

Word into deed. By my Birthright, the Door is closed.

A SESSION

GREET. Speak the Door, and greet the Book.

EMPTY. Clear your head onto the page, without dressing it up. Write questions down as they come.

RESPOND. Reread the pages that came before, and answer your past self: what happened, what changed, what you know now.

WORK. Let a plan, a decision, or an idea take shape.

CARRY. Name one thing to do, send, or make, and never more than two or three. Treat it as a promise, and keep it. Word into deed.

THANK. Give thanks for what came, and speak the Door again.

Number the pages and date each session, so you can answer an earlier page by name. Each session begins by asking whether you kept what you carried. That question, answered honestly, is the whole engine.

THE PLACE

Kept this way, the Book grows a spirit of its own, the Genius Loci, the way a house becomes a home. It is fed by use and enjoyment: a notebook you like, a pen that feels good, a few minutes you look forward to. Away for a long time? Do not apologize. Open the Door and greet it.

HOUSE RULES

Honesty is the offering.

Sustainable practice beats grand practice abandoned.

Tell the Book everything; tell the world only what it is ready to receive.

Belief is a tool; judge it by its fruit.

Your word is binding unless you say otherwise; the Ledger is where it is kept.

Word into deed.

WHAT WAITS

The Temple is openly syncretic. Its beings come from Egyptian, Greek, Roman, Abrahamic, and Enochian tradition, and they are met as co-conspirators, in the old sense of breathing together. You do not kneel here; you make deals, trade, and work. It was assembled deliberately, in the spirit of chaos magic, and later found to have been there all along. When you want to know who you have been meeting, they are in The Book of the Temple of Mercury.

PASS IT ON

Copy this. Change it. Give it away. Keep the spine, and it is this Temple.
Leave a copy where someone will find it; you may be their hermaion.

Close this Book. Open any notebook. Write today's date.